三　寶

一、前言

感謝天恩師德、老前人、前人慈悲大德，給後學這個機會學講「三寶」，同時也要衷心的恭喜大家來參加法會，進一步研究道理。今天能夠來開這個法會，不但是大家祖上積德，更是前世有修，這輩子才有機會來開這個殊勝的法會，所以請大家平心靜氣、主敬存誠，認眞來聆聽法會的內容。

在法會還沒有正式的進行之前，由後學來爲大家複習三寶。相信很多前賢求道之後，因爲時間上的關係，事隔多日，沒有把三寶記得很清楚。今天，後學就來跟大家做個複習。

請大家要先瞭解，我們求的道是先天大道，也是佛家講的「上乘大法」。這個道和當時釋迦摩尼佛，觀世音菩薩所得的道是完全一樣的。道自古不輕傳，在以前，欲求眞道者必千里訪明師，萬里求口訣。現今時，因爲三期末劫年，人心不古，世道敗壞，所以上天慈悲，不忍玉石俱焚，善惡不分，於是大開普渡，派遣明師倒裝下世傳道，這兩位偉大的明師就是濟公活佛和月慧菩薩。在道場，老天慈悲垂下天命給眞修實辦，德行俱足的修道人，他們領有天命替師傳道，我們尊稱他們爲點傳師。求道時，點傳師代替天命明師將宇宙的眞理傳給我們，即是「三寶」，現在就由後學來跟大家做個複習。

1. 玄關竅
2. 口訣
3. 合同

二、三寶

(一)　玄關竅

求道時，天命明師藉由傳道師的手，在我們額前點玄，指點了我們一條光明大覺路，這是通天之窄門，使我們一點超生。

玄關竅是靈性出入肉身之門户，當靈性與肉身相合即生，靈性與肉身分離即死。聖經創世紀第二章第七節提到，上帝捏土造人，在人的鼻孔裡吹進一口氣，這個人就活了。所捏的土是人的肉體，吹進去的氣就是靈性。沒有這口氣，這個人僅是一撮土而已，是沒有生命的。所以活著時，靈性在身體內生氣蓬勃，是肉體的主宰，我們稱靈性爲眞我、本性。靈性出入身體的玄妙之門，到底在那兒？人出生時，不朽的靈性進入身體，此門即關閉鎖住。倘若不遇明師將之開啓，臨命終時，靈性將無法從正門離開身體。根據佛經的記載，由旁門出離的靈魂將墮入生死輪迴，轉世爲人或動物，端視生前的所作所爲，也就是「業」，因爲不同的業，靈魂就由不同的旁門出去：

耳：由耳出去者，來生當爲胎生動物，如馬、豬、牛、羊之類。
眼：由眼出去者，來生當爲卵生動物，如飛鳥之類。
口：由口出去者，來生當爲濕生動物，如魚、蝦之類。
鼻：由鼻出去者，來生當爲化生動物，如蒼蠅、飛蛾、蜜蜂之類。
肚臍：由肚臍出去者，來生當爲平庸之人。
頂門：由頂門出去者，來生當爲富貴之人。

上述之路乃生死輪迴之路，不能脫出苦海，唯有由正門而出者，才能超脫而登天堂。

子曰：「誰能出不由户，何莫由斯道也。」又云：「朝聞道，夕死可矣。」可見玄關竅關乎生死、四生六道的輪迴，是靈性出入的門户；得之，即可了脫輪迴之苦，故云夕死可矣。聖經提到的「窄門」，亦指此靈性出入的門户。

在馬太福音第十六章二十四節，與路加福音第九章二十三節裡，耶穌基督對他的門徒說：「若有人要跟從我，就當捨己，背起他的十字架來跟從我。」這十字架是無形的，並非有形的，在玄關竅這個地方，是每個人與生俱來的良心本性，光明導師。在馬太福音第六章二十二節裡，耶穌也說：「眼睛是身上的燈，你的眼睛若瞭亮，全身就光明。你的眼睛若昏花，全身就黑暗。你裡頭的光若黑暗了，那黑暗是何等的大呢。」英文版的經文中，眼睛是以單數呈現，指的就是佛陀開示迦葉尊者所說的「正法眼藏」，非左右雙眼，不只暗指玄關一竅，更教導世人莫誤了這無形的救世主，眞正的十字架。此外，更印證了大學中庸的「愼獨」，與佛家的「禪」，即「示單」。路加福音繼續提到：「所以，你要省察，恐怕你　頭的光或者黑暗了。若是你全身光明，毫無黑暗，就必全然光明，如同燈的明光照亮你。」師父引進門，修行在個人；求道之後還必須修道，正如心經開宗明義所說：「觀自在菩薩，行深般若波羅密多時，照見五蘊皆空，度一切苦厄。」可見五教本來同源。

所以，我們平日要意守玄關，常保心平氣和，放鬆自己，自然的呼吸，愼防心思飄遠，心煩意亂，這樣有助於收攝心神、增長智慧、啓發生命力。

(二)　口訣

口訣共有五個字，稱作五字眞言，是通天的密咒，眞我本性與上天連繫的管道。

聖經啓示錄第二章第十七節提到：「聖靈向眾教會所說的話，凡有耳的，就應當聽。得勝的，我必將那隱藏的嗎哪賜給他，並賜他一塊白石，石上寫著新名。除了那領受的以外，沒有人能認識。」的確，只有得到新名字的人才瞭解此心法的眞意、才能分享到上帝的榮耀，這新名字是入天堂的暗碼。

聖保羅在腓利比書第二章第八、九節說：「…凡謙卑、存心順服，以至於死，且死在十字架上，神將他升爲至高，又賜給他那超乎萬名之上的名，叫一切在天上的、地上的、和地底下的，因耶穌的名，無不屈膝…」因得了此新名字，我們才可以受到神光的照耀、進入天堂。彌勒祖師奉老中之命執掌天盤，我們的師尊和師母，即濟公活佛和月慧菩薩，也是領命擔負救渡三曹的重任。得此新名字的人正是聖殿的柱石，受上帝的重視而永生。啓示錄第三章第十二節上帝說：「得勝的，我要叫他在我神殿中作柱子，他也必不再從那裡出去。我又要將我神的名和我神城的名，並我的新名，都寫在他上面。」上帝從不令得有新名字的人落入輪迴，而是令他們在天上得永生。求道時有張文件表格叫龍天表，亦叫做生命册上的掛號單；表文昇天，天榜掛號，地府抽丁，這是非比尋常的。我們一定要感恩、珍惜。

口訣共有幾個字？其義又如何？現在，我們就來探討一下，口訣共有五個

字，頭三個字代表的是宇宙的理、氣、象三天，亦即無極、太極、皇極。

(1) 理天(無極)：是道的本體、寂然不動、恆常不變。

(2) 氣天(太極)：是道的動象，它生陰生陽，陰陽互動是宇宙萬物創造的根源，是個相對的現象界，其中的變化是週而復始，永無休止。

(3) 象天(皇極)：這是我們所居住的世界，所有實體的東西都是陰陽互動而產生的，看得見、摸得著，卻短暫、恆變的，有成即有毀。看看這張桌子，誰知道過了一百年，它會變成如何？可能已經毀了。現在，你我都在這佛堂裡，一百年以後呢？我們還在這世上嗎？倘若是，又是何種模樣？依然精力充沛嗎？試著想想看。所以，人世間的一切是短暫的、有限制的、會毀壞的。所有的生物，不管是植物、動物、人，都會歷經成、住、壞、空。

口訣的後兩字代表的是彌勒佛。彌勒是梵文，翻成中文是「慈」，故彌勒菩薩從初發心就不食眾生肉。「慈」意指除去人們的痛苦，帶給他們安慰、關懷、和快樂。請看坐在供桌上的彌勒佛雕像，他正對著我們微笑，這麼快樂的樣子，怎麼會這樣的快樂呢？諸位可能認為這世上充滿著挫折、困難、挑戰、或悲傷，無人能擺脫；諸位也可能認為修道是很辛苦的一件事，所謂忍人所不能忍，行人所不能行。其實一切的痛苦、執著、計較來自人心，自性是解脫、清靜、自在的。彌勒佛正示現一種真修實煉、恢復本性之慈悲瀟灑風範。，以祂的寬容、慈悲，能夠化苦難為快樂，所以大家叫祂歡喜佛，所謂大肚能容，了卻人間多少事；滿腔歡喜，笑開天下古今愁。

平日內心常默念五字真言，好好修持，並且對道要有堅定的信念，必可得到仙佛的庇佑。

(三) 合同

第三實是合同，也叫做手印。合同意指與天地宇宙合而為一，亦指和上天之相互約定。

在我們的右手有十二個代表宇宙週期的點——子、丑、寅、卯、辰、巳、午、未、申、酉、戌、亥。手抱合同時，左右拇指掐在代表宇宙起始和結束的子、亥兩點，這就像是乾坤在握。古時希臘以α代表時間的起點、Ω為終點。啓示錄第一章第八節上帝告訴世人說：「我是α，我是Ω(α，Ω是希臘字母的首末二字)，是昔在、今在、以後永在的全能者。」「昔在、今在、以後永在」代表大道本體的不生不滅、無始無終。所以，手抱合同就是代表誠心抱守自性清靜的本體，才能與上帝合一，永不迷失。

手抱合同時，兩手緊抱，不漏縫，平放在胸前，子亥相掐，合而成「孩」字，表示孩童、嬰孩的意思，與天地合一，就要有赤子之心，以純真的本性是與上天相通，也代表上帝與人的關係是一種父子的關係。在聖經馬太福音第十八章第一到四節曾提到，彼時，耶穌的門徒問道：「天國裡誰最大？」耶穌便

叫一個小孩過來，說：「我實在告訴你們，你們若不回轉，變成小孩子的樣式，斷不能進天國。」所以，凡自己謙卑像這小孩子的，他在天國裡就是最大的。路加福音第十八章第十七節更繼續提到耶穌所說的話：「我實在告訴你們，凡要承受神國的，若不像小孩子，斷不能進去。」第十章第二十一節「耶穌說，父啊，天地的主，我感謝你，因爲你將這些事，向聰明通達人，就藏起來，向嬰孩，就顯出來。」換言之，要進入天國，與上帝在一起，必須具有像孩子般純眞的本性，孟老夫子所謂的「赤子之心」。小孩或小嬰兒不貪、不怨、不吹毛求疵、也沒有分別心，這純眞的本性正是我們應該努力彰顯的。

現在，讓我們一起來練習三寶！眼睛八分閉，心神集中在玄關竅，默念五字眞言，手抱合同，平放胸前，並懷著感恩平靜之心。

三寶是修持的好方法，用三寶修持，好處很多：在世可以逢凶化吉、躲劫避難，百年之後更能超生了死、成聖成賢。另外，要提醒大家，三寶是上天與你之間以心印心的祕法，千萬不要洩漏天機，即使親如父母配偶兄弟姊妹也一樣要守口如瓶，但可以把他們帶到佛堂來求道。還有一點，如果忘了三寶，怎麼辦？一定要回到佛堂，點了三盞佛燈，才能幫你複習。

以上簡單的說明三寶，希望有助於各位對三寶進一步的瞭解。最後，再次的祝賀大家來參加法會，並祝大家修道路上一帆風順。若是講的不圓滿，叩求老中、仙佛慈悲赦罪。謝謝大家。

THE THREE TREASURES

I am grateful to the grace of Heaven, virtues of Holy Teachers and the blessings of Lao Qian Ren and Qian Ren, so that I can have this chance of lecturing on the "Three Treasures". At the same time, I sincerely welcome and congratulate you for being able to attend this Tao Seminar to learn more about the Truth. For you to be able to attend this Tao Seminar, not only because of the abundant virtues of your ancestors; what's more important is your cultivating merits of past lives, which enable you to be a formal member of the Tao Seminar. Please be calm and respectful, be conscientiously sincere and listen attentively to the content of all lectures.

I. Introduction

Before this Tao Seminar formally gets underway, please allow me to humbly review the Three Treasures with you. Most of you, because of time constraints during Tao Receiving Ceremony and the length of time lapsed since you were introduced of the Three Treasures for the very first time, have faint memories of the Three Treasures. This is why at the beginning of the Tao Seminar, we are having a review of this most precious innate wealth we all possess.

Please do understand that the Tao we received is the Truth that exists before the creation of universe. IT is also known as the "supreme Dharma" in Buddhism. What we have received is exactly the same Tao as what Sakyamuni Buddha and Guan Yin (Avalokitesvara) Bodhisattva had received in ancient times, but Tao was not easily transmitted in ancient times. Before

the turn for White Sun Era, cultivators had to search for the Enlightened Master all over the land for the Mantra, only which could lead to enlightenment and transcend sufferings. Now time is ripe for the last salvation, but people do not esteem the traditional moral values as important anymore; social orders and public morality seem to deteriorate with the passage of time. Therefore, the merciful Almighty cannot bear to see the righteous suffer with the deluded villains, and granted the last salvation to be carried out by the Enlightening Masters, who are our Holy Teachers, the great Ji-Gong Living Buddha and Yue-Hui Bodhisattva. In the Tao society, the Almighty has mercifully bestowed Heavenly Decree to the ones who have been truthfully cultivating and propagating Tao since their initiations. These true cultivators are complete with virtues and merits, and with the mandate of heaven, they can represent our Holy Teachers to transmit Tao, so we reverently call them Dian Chuan Shi, or Tao Transmitting Masters. During the Tao Receiving Ceremony, they assume the physical representation of the heavenly mandated Enlightening Masters to pass on the universal Truth to us; this universal Truth/cosmic principles are packaged as the Three Treasures. Now, let's review these inherent treasures.

4. Heavenly Portal (Holy Gate)
5. Heavenly Password (Holy Mantra)
6. Heavenly Hand Sign (Holy Covenant)

II. The Three Treasures

1. Heavenly Portal (Holy Gate)

During the Tao Receiving Ceremony, the Heavenly Decreed Enlightening Master used the hand of a Tao Transmitting Master to point at our faces; at that instant a bright, enlightening path was recovered for us. This path is the narrow gate leading us back to heaven, which enables us to transcend the cycles of birth and death.

Heavenly Portal is the Gate from which spirit enters and exits a physical body; this is why it's holy and when the spirit leaves a body at the right time through this Holy Gate, the spirit will return to heaven; thus, the Portal leading back to heaven. When spirit joins and dwells with a body, a person is said to be living; when separated, death occurs. In the Bible, Genesis 2:7 stated, "And the LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul." Dust is the body of a man, the breath of life is the spirit; without this breath, a man is but a mount of dust without life. When living, the spirit is within a body and full of vitality; it is the lord of body, so we call the spirit True-Self, True-Nature. However, where is this mysterious, oracular Gate which spirit comes in and out of the body? When a person was born, this Gate was closed and locked as spirit entered the body through it. Were it not for the Enlightening Master to unlock and reopen this Gate, at the moment of death the spirit would not be able to exit through this "right" Gate. Based on the Buddhist sutras, a spirit leaving through side-doors would still be entangled in reincarnation. To be reborn as a human or animal depends on what

one had done in the previous life, which is called "karma". Because of different karma, a spirit exits through different side-doors:

(1) Ears: If a spirit leaves through ears, it will be reborn as a viviparous animal, such as a horse, sheep, cow, pig, etc.
(2) Eyes: If a spirit leaves through eyes, it will be reborn as an oviparous animal, such as a bird, chicken, duck, etc.
(3) Mouth: If a spirit leaves through mouth, it will be reborn as creatures of water, such as a fish, lobster, crab, etc.
(4) Nose: If a spirit leaves through nose, it will be reborn as insects, such as a fly, moth, bee, beetle, mosquito, etc.
(5) Navel: If a spirit l leaves through navel, it will be reborn as an ordinary person.
(6) Vertex: If a spirit leaves through vertex, it will be reborn as a wealthy and powerful person.

The above-mentioned side-doors will lead spirits to the reincarnations and cannot transcend the sea of sufferings. Only by leaving through the Holy Gate, Heavenly Portal, can one transcend these sufferings and return to heaven.

Confucius said, "Who can exit without going through the right gate? Everyone must go through the path of Tao!" He also said, "As a person comprehends the essence of Tao in the morning, he may well die content in the evening." Therefore, the Heavenly Portal is of vital importance to birth and death, and so is it to the reincarnations of the six-byways. If spirit exits through the Portal, then one can transcend the sufferings of reincarnation and return to heaven, which explains why Confucius said of "die content in the evening". The "Narrow Gate" mentioned in Holy Bible also refers to the Heavenly Portal through which spirit enters and exits a functional body.

In Matthew 16:24 and Luke 9:23, Jesus said unto his disciples; "If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me." The cross is metaphysical, not tangible. It has no forms. It is right where the Heavenly Portal is, which is the inherent conscience everyone possesses and is also known as the True-Nature, the guiding master to enlightenment. In Matthew 6:22-23, Jesus also said, "The light of the body is the eye: if therefore thine eye be single, thy whole body shall be full of light. But if thine eye be evil, thy whole body shall be full of darkness, how great is that darkness!" Please note that the "eye" is singular form, it is referring to the same "eye" as the "supreme Ddharma/Truth hidden within the eye" that Lord Buddha, Sakyamuni, taught the Reverend Jiashe in a Dharma meeting. This eye is neither the left eye nor the right eye; it is not only implying the Holy Gate, but also telling people not to fall for the six thieves of senses losing in the midst of all the delusions and confusions the intangible Christ within, which is exactly the true Cross inherent in each and every one of us. The singular "eye" also provides profound insights into a key concept of "being cautious/watchful when alone" in Confucian classics The Great Learning and Doctrine of the Mean. It corresponds to the Chinese character "Zen", which is written in the way combined by two characters meaning "showing" and "single". To further exemplify it, in Luke 11:35-36 of the Bible stated, "Take heed therefore that the light which is in thee be not darkness. If thy whole body

therefore be full of light, having no part dark, the whole shall be full of light, as when the bright shinning of a candle doth give thee light." Now, we come to a striking understanding of what "the light in thee" and "the candle within" are referring to. Note the "Bodhisattva within" stated in the opening of the Heart Sutra, "Bodhisattva Avalokitesvara (Observe the Bodhisattva within oneself), exert on cultivation and practice Prajna Paramita (Meditate deeply with the wisdom and going beyond), perceive all five skandhas in their own being that are inherently empty, save all sufferers." There is a famous Chinese proverb, "The master can only lead you to the door, but whether you want to enter the house and learn is a personal matter." Thus, after receiving Tao, in order to attain the ultimate perfection, a person must count on himself striving to cultivate. Now we all have received Tao, we know the "showing the single" is actually showing the True-Nature; "be watchful when alone" meaning "be always conscientious about each and every rising thought". These are but few examples of profound insightful verses that are illustrated here. The list may go on. So it's very clear that the five world religions and all teachings on the Truth are of the same origin.

Therefore, we should let the True-Nature preside within the Heavenly Portal, guard the conscience in every moment, maintain a calm heart and peaceful disposition, relaxed and breathe naturally; cautiously refrain thoughts from deviating afar so as not to be distraught and distracted. This will help tremendously in conserving our vital energy, keeping high spirited, enhancing wisdom then asserting these precious forces for the positive and meaningful goals in life.

2. Heavenly Password (Holy Mantra)

The Heavenly Password has five words, called Holy Mantra, which is of the utmost value and mystery in leading one to heaven. It is a powerful bond between one's true self and the heavenly world.

In Revelation 2:17, "He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it." Therefore, only they who are granted a new name can understand the true meaning of this heart Dharma living in great glory of God. It is the password of entering heaven.

Saint Paul said in Philippians 2:8-9, "And being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself, and became obedient unto death, even the death of the cross. Wherefore God also hath highly exalted him, and given him a name which is above every name." With this Heavenly Password, we are given a name and assigned a place in the heavenly world, our eternal home. It is all because of our Maitreya Buddha, Ji-Gong Living Buddha, and Yue-Hui Bodhisattva, who are ordained with heavenly decree to complete the last salvation, hence we can all bask in God's grace receiving Tao and following in the footsteps of past saints and sages. God said in Revelation 3:12, "Him that overcometh will I make a pillar in the temple of my God, and he shall go no more out: and I will write upon him the name of my God, and the name of the city of my God, which is new Jerusalem, which cometh down out of heaven from my God: and I will write upon him my new name."

They who receive the new name are pillars in the temple. They rest from the birth and death cycle, for they enjoy eternal life. Remember the heavenly document called Long Tian Biao in the Tao receiving ceremony? It is the registration form to the book of life. When this heavenly document is burned, your name is being registered in heaven, deleted from the underworld, which is something extremely extraordinary. So we must be appreciative and grateful.

In the Heavenly Password, how many words are there? What is their respective meaning? Now let me explain the five words of the Heavenly Password.

The first three words represent the heavenly world, the spiritual world, and the earthly world, which are also called Wu Ji, Tai Ji, and Huang Ji.

(1) Heavenly world (Wu Ji, the absolute realm): It is the quintessential state of Tao, originally tranquil, non-moving, and non-changing.

(2) Chi world (Tai Ji, the relative realm): It is the Tao in motion and manifestation. It gives rise to yin and yang, which interact to procreate all existence. The cyclical change is the intrinsic attribute of this phenomenal world.

(3) Earthly world (Huang Ji, the physical realm): This is the world where we live, a world where all existence are shown that can be seen, heard, or felt. They are transient and liable to change. Take this table, or this Temple for example, after one hundred years, what shall become of it? Maybe it's gone. Now you and I are together in this Temple, where would we be in hundred years' time? Are we still here? If so, then what would we look like, still being so energetic as now we are? Therefore, the state of the earthly world is characterized by temporality, limitation and deterioration. All existence in this world including all vegetation, animals, humans and all, are subject to birth and death.

The last two words of the Mantra represent the Maitreya Buddha, which is a Sanskrit word meaning mercy and compassion. Mercy refrains from killing and compassion eradicates suffering. Look at the Maitreya Buddha's statue on the altar. He is smiling at us. Why is he so happy? This world is full of frustration, difficulty, challenge, and sorrow, which no one can deny. It is impossible for anyone to avoid the fact of life and to always be cheerful. But Maitreya Buddha is different. With his great tolerance and compassion, he can transform sadness into bliss. That is why he is commonly known as the Laughing Buddha or the Happy Buddha. Maitreya Buddha is characterized by his smiling face and big belly. His smiling face expresses his compassionate, sincere and joyful nature. He has nothing to hide, nothing to get attached. His big belly signifies his big capacity, embracing all things, good or bad, with great tolerance and acceptance.

Therefore, in our daily life, we can quietly chant the Holy Mantra and cultivate in accordance with it. With faith, we will be blessed with Buddhas' guidance and protection.

3. Heavenly Hand Sign (Holy Covenant)

The Third Treasure is Heavenly Hand Sign, or Holy Covenant, which means our unification with the whole universe. It also means a holy promise to God.

In the Chinese tradition, on our right hand there are twelve points which represent the twelve cycles of the time – Zi, Chou, Ying, Mao, Chen, Si, Wu, Wei, Shen, You, Shu, Hai. While holding the Hand Sign, we press our thumbs on what symbolizes the beginning of the universe called Zi and the ending cycle called Hai, which means we hold the whole time transcending the limitation of time. In ancient Greece, they used Alpha to denote the starting point of time, and Omega the ending point. In Revelation 22:13 of the Holy Bible, "I am, the beginning and the ending, saith the Lord, which is, and which was, and which is to come, the Almighty." In this passage, "is", "was", and "is to come" collectively means exceeding the boundary of time, which also means, throughout the time, we are being sincere and dedicated to the original pure and solemn nature given by God, we are being at one with God and holding communion with God, never ever go astray.

When holding the Hand Sign, leave no gaps in between the fingers while placing it in front of your chest. The starting point Zi and the ending point Hai can combine to form another Chinese character Hai, which means "child". That means we must restore a pure and innocent heart just like a child in order to hold communion with God. It also signifies the relationship between God and humans, which is like that between father and children. In the Holy Bible, Matthew 18:1-4, "At the same time came the disciples unto Jesus, saying, Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven? And Jesus called a little child unto him, and set him in the midst of them, And said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven. Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom of heaven." Also, Luke 10:21 further relays Jesus' teachings, "In that hour Jesus rejoiced in spirit, and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes: even so, Father; for so it seemed good in thy sight." In other words, to enter the kingdom of God and be with God, we must restore our instinctive nature of innocence, which is known in Confucian term as a "childlike heart", being pure, candid, and righteous. A little baby is not polluted by greed or hatred, neither is he judgmental, calculating, or discriminating. Such is the pure and original nature we should strive to manifest.

III. Practicing the Three Treasures

Now let us practice the Three Treasures together! Close your eyes eighty percent and focus your attention on the Heavenly Portal; quietly recite the Heavenly Password in your mind; hold the Heavenly Hand Sign in front of your chest. Be calm and thankful.

Practicing the Three Treasure paves the way to cultivation, and the merits are boundless. It mobilizes heavenly protection that can help us to experience fewer calamities or even escape the impending ones. It further helps us transcend the birth-and-death cycle and join with all the saints and sages attaining immortality in heaven. Besides, I must remind you to keep the Three Treasures a holy secret between Heaven and you. It is an esoteric teaching from heart to heart, so don't disclose it to others even though they are intimate to you like your parents, spouse,

brothers, or sisters. If you want to share with them the Three Treasures, bring them to the Temple and receive Tao. Only through the Tao Receiving Ceremony can their Heavenly Portal be unlocked and reopened. As for yourself, if you forgot the Three Treasures, what would you do? You should come back to the Temple, light up the three holy lamps before you review the Three Treasures with the Tao members.

The above is a brief explanation of the Three Treasures. I wish to help you further understand The Three Treasures. If you have any doubts or questions, please do not hesitate to voice them out for clarification. Finally, my heartiest congratulations once again for your being able to attend the Tao seminar. I wish you all the best in your journey of Tao cultivation. I beg to apologize to our Heavenly Mother and Buddhas if I should make any mistakes in the speech. Thank you very much for your listening.

學英文的十個訣竅

Ten Tips for Learning English as a Second Language

"What's the best way to learn a language?"

Many students and teachers have asked this question, and the answers are as different as the people asking the question. Here I will give you several tips for learning English. They are based on my own experience in learning languages. These tips helped me when I learned a foreign language, and I hope that they will help you as you work on improving your English.

1. Want to learn.

First of all, you must want to learn. If you are not interested in learning English, no class will help you, no book will help you, and no hints will make it easier. If you are not interested, you will find reasons to avoid studying, and whenever you do study, it will be very difficult. So you have to be honest with yourself. Ask yourself, "Do I really want to learn English?" If you can't answer "yes" to this question, it is better for you to set English aside until you're ready and willing to learn.

2. Identify your motivation.

Next, you need to identify your motivation. Ask yourself, "Why do I want to learn English? Why do I want to improve my English?" Some people want to learn English to get a better job, or to be considered for a promotion. Other people may need to learn English to attend university or school. Still other people may want to learn English so they can enjoy life in America more, by being able to understand movies and TV, and make friends with their American neighbors. Each person is different, so their motivations will be different also. If you have identified your motivation, it will be easier for you to learn English, because it will help to encourage you as you learn English.

3. Set goals.

Once you have identified your motivation, you can set some goals for learning